

AI Employee Handbook

Executive Summary — Workshop Handout

This package is designed as a **copy-and-paste class handout** for your AI workshop. It follows the same teaching logic already established in your slide deck: **AI gets more useful when it has business context**, and the simplest way to provide that context is through four clear files that function like an "AI Employee Handbook."

The deliverable is written for non-technical small business owners, keeps the language plain, and is structured so attendees can fill in the blanks and use the files right away.

Plain Language

Written for non-technical small business owners — no jargon, no coding required.

Fill-in-the-Blank

Templates with examples, short and long samples, and prompt snippets ready to use.

Use Right Away

Structured so attendees leave class with working files, not just theory.

Why These Four Files Work

Your current deck separates context into four distinct roles. That separation is valuable because it makes the files **easier to maintain**, **reduces contradictions**, and lets business owners update one part of their context without rewriting everything else.

Who the person is

me.md — Your identity, role, and goals so the AI understands who it's working for.

How the brand sounds

brandguidelines.md — Tone, voice, and style so every output feels on-brand.

What the company knows

companyknowledge.md — Products, services, and facts so the AI stays accurate.

What rules the AI must follow

rules.md — Guardrails and constraints so the AI never goes off-script.

The Core Insight

The document preserves this four-part structure and converts it into practical templates — complete with examples, prompt snippets, and simple upkeep guidance.

Update one file without rewriting everything else. Each file has a single job. That's the power of the system.

The Four Markdown Files — Full Templates

These four Markdown files act like a simple AI employee handbook for a small business. They help an LLM answer with more context by telling it who you are, how your brand sounds, what your business knows, and what rules it must follow.

- ❗ The goal is not to make these files *perfect*. The goal is to make them **useful**. Good context files are: true, specific, easy to update, written in plain English, and organized so both people and AI can skim them quickly.

If you only have limited time, complete in this order:

01

me.md

Your identity, role, business goals, and background. Start here — it anchors everything else.

02

companyknowledge.md

Products, services, pricing, FAQs, and key facts about your business.

03

brandguidelines.md

Tone of voice, style preferences, words to use and avoid.

04

rules.md

Hard constraints, compliance notes, and things the AI must never do or say.

Writing Tips for Every File

- Use **short bullet points** when possible — AI skims just like humans do.
- **Add dates** to anything that changes often, like pricing or team members.
- If you **don't know something yet**, say so plainly instead of guessing.
- Keep each file focused on **one job only** — don't mix brand voice into rules.md.

me.md — starter template

Name: [Your name]

Role: [Your title or role in the business]

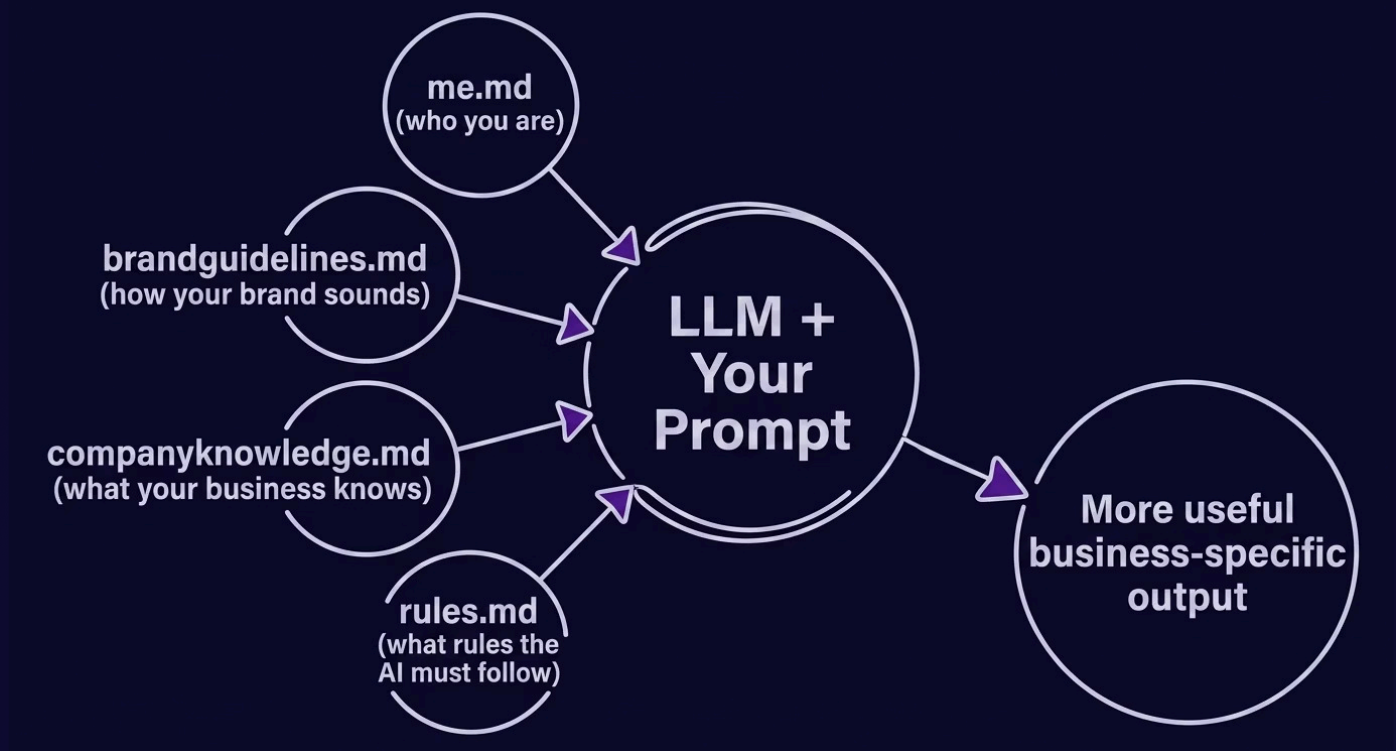
Business: [Business name and one-sentence description]

Goals: [What you are trying to accomplish this quarter]

Background: [Relevant experience or context the AI should know]

How It All Connects

Every file feeds into the same moment: when you send a prompt to an LLM. The diagram below shows how the four files combine with your prompt to produce **more useful, business-specific output** — instead of a generic answer that could belong to anyone.



This is the core lesson of the workshop: **context is the skill**. The four files are not a technical trick — they are a thinking framework. Once attendees understand that AI responds to what it's given, they stop blaming the tool and start improving the input.

Key Takeaway for Attendees

- You don't need to be technical to do this
- Four plain text files is all it takes to start
- Update one file at a time as your business changes
- Better input always produces better output